Policy & Strategy Lab

Workbook 3: Institutions and Actors

Participant	
Name	
Case (problem statement)	
Decision-making role and decision	
Pod	

How to use this workbook

Each worksheet applies one day's anchor tool to your own case. Complete it during the session and finish it in your independent time. Keep earlier versions: revision is credited, so record what changed and why in the feedback box at the end of each worksheet. Tag every substantive claim in your Analyst's Ledger as fact, inference, assumption or hypothesis.

Competencies practised in this workbook: D1, D2, D3, D4, D5.

Using AI tools. You may use AI tools to suggest structures, rival explanations or improvements to your writing. You may not use AI output as evidence. Every fact, figure, citation and description of an institution must come from a source you have checked.

Worksheet 3.1: Jurisdiction, funding and delivery chain

Day 6: Jurisdiction, money and delivery. Anchor tool: Delivery chain map.

Purpose. Establish who can act on your problem, with what money, and where delivery is most likely to break.

In brief.

- Legislative authority, administrative control and money often sit with different bodies.
- Address your recommendation to the body that can act, and find the budget line that would pay for it.
- Map the delivery chain: failures usually sit at a specific link.
- PESTLE is a check for missing branches, not an essay.

Worked example: Madhyapur (a stylised city; figures are illustrative). Madhyapur: solid waste management is a Twelfth Schedule function; public health and sanitation and local government are State List subjects. Funding: the mission's central and state shares, Finance Commission grants to urban local bodies and the corporation's own revenue. Chain: Union ministry, state department, corporation, ward staff, contractor crews, households. Likely break: between ward staff and crews.

Instructions.

1. Find where your subject sits in the Constitution and record the entry.
2. Identify the scheme or budget head that funds the activity and the sharing pattern, with year and source.
3. Map the delivery chain from policy-maker to citizen.
4. Mark the link where delivery most likely breaks, and the evidence you would need.
5. Run the PESTLE check on your issue tree; add only factors that change the analysis.

Three kinds of power

Power	Which body holds it	Source (article, list entry or scheme guideline)
Legislative authority		
Administrative control		
Funding		

Funding route

Scheme or budget head	Who pays what share	Latest allocation (amount, year, source)

Delivery chain

Link	Who	What they do	Evidence that this link works or fails

Link	Who	What they do	Evidence that this link works or fails

PESTLE completeness check

Factor	Missing from my tree?	Add a branch? Why
Political		
Economic		
Social		
Technological		
Legal		
Environmental		

A thinker for your case: Lant Pritchett and Devesh Kapur. At which link in the delivery chain does intent at the top stop becoming action on the ground?

My answer, in one sentence

Reflection.

1. Is your decision-maker the body that holds the power your recommendation will need? If not, who is?
2. Pritchett and Kapur: at which link does intent stop becoming action in your case?
3. Which PESTLE factor did you add, and why does it change the analysis?

My reflections

Quality checklist.

- ☐ The three powers are identified separately, with sources.
- ☐ The funding route has a year and a source.

- ☐ The chain has five or six links and a marked break point.
- ☐ PESTLE additions are justified.

Hand in. Worksheet 3.1 by the start of Day 7.

Before the next session. Find the most recent budget figure for the scheme or head that funds your problem, with year and source, and note it for your evidence register (which opens on Day 10). Check whether a CAG report, standing committee report or social audit has examined the service. About 45 minutes.

Feedback and revision

Feedback received (peer or instructor)	What I changed, and why

Worksheet 3.2: Stakeholder and incentive matrix

Day 7: Actors and political economy. Anchor tool: Power-interest map with absent voices.

Purpose. Show who shapes your problem, what each actor is rewarded for, and who bears costs without a voice.

In brief.

- Map power and interest, then ask who has no voice.
- Incentives explain behaviour better than attitudes. Write what the system rewards.
- The rules in use can differ sharply from the rules on paper.
- Feasibility is political: find who can block change and what would bring them along.

Worked example: Madhyapur (a stylised city; figures are illustrative). Madhyapur: the Commissioner, councillors and the contractor are high power and high interest; waste pickers, sanitation workers and residents near the landfill are high interest with little voice. Rule on paper: households must separate. Rule in use: the truck takes everything.

Instructions.

1. List every actor in and beyond your delivery chain who affects or is affected by the problem.
2. Place each on the power-interest map.
3. For each key actor, write what they want, what the system rewards and their likely response to change.
4. Identify at least one group with high interest and little voice.
5. Record one rule in use that differs from the rule on paper, with evidence.

Power-interest map

Actor	Power (high or low)	Interest (high or low)	Quadrant

Incentive matrix

Actor	What they want	What the system rewards now	Likely response to change

Actor	What they want	What the system rewards now	Likely response to change

Rules on paper and rules in use

Rule on paper	Rule in use	Evidence

A thinker for your case: Elinor Ostrom and Michael Lipsky. Which rules actually govern behaviour here, and what will frontline workers really do?

My answer, in one sentence

Reflection.

1. Lipsky: what will the frontline worker in your case actually do with a new instruction?
2. Who could block your likely recommendation, and how?
3. Whose voice is missing from the evidence you have read so far?

My reflections

Quality checklist.

- ☐ At least eight actors are mapped.
- ☐ Incentives describe what the system rewards.
- ☐ At least one absent voice is identified.
- ☐ One rule in use is documented with evidence.

Hand in. Worksheet 3.2 by the start of Day 8.

Before the next session. Find one published source that records the experience of the absent voice in your case, such as a field study, a social audit, testimony to a committee or credible reporting. Note what it adds to your map. About 45 minutes.

Feedback and revision

Feedback received (peer or instructor)	What I changed, and why